



**A mobile phone with a 12-megapixel camera. Enough said.**

you might as well equip it with Xenon flash and autofocus for those 4000x3000 pixel images, and video LED flash for night-time shooting – and Sony has done just that. Geo-tagging? Check. Face detection? Check. Smile shutter? Check. Image stabilisation? Check. If it wasn't for the lack of good optical zoom, the phone would be better equipped than quite a few digital cameras out there.

Oh yes, we almost forgot that it's a phone too! The 3.5-inch touchscreen TFT will let you view all the images you click at a maximum resolution of 360x640 pixels; but at least the colours will be rich, since it can render 16 million of them.

There has been no word on the kind of hardware it is running on, although the company has confirmed that the operating system will be based on Symbian. The lack of information about built-in memory makes us think that a large microSD card will be all you get in the Idou.

Rumoured to have a release scheduled for October, the 3G handset comes with the usual host of technologies: Wi-Fi, Bluetooth with A2DP, stereo FM with RDS, GPS and A-GPS, secondary VGA camera for video calls, etc.